



TMC<sub>221</sub> • TOTAL MAN CONCEPT

# Positive Thinking and Creative Problem-Solving

The W.I.S.E. Model — a unified framework drawn from five  
transformative works

WISDOM

NEUROSCIENCE

CREATIVITY

FAITH

PROBLEM-SOLVING

# The 5 Voices Behind One Framework

Five Books. One Conversation.



This lecture draws from 5 works across five decades:

**1 Winning Wisdom**

Dr. David O. Oyedepo

**2 Switch On Your Brain**

Dr. Caroline Leaf

**3 The Power of Positive Thinking**

Norman Vincent Peale

**4 Lateral Thinking**

Edward de Bono

**5 A Technique for Producing Ideas**

James Webb Young

# Introducing the W.I.S.E. Model

## The W.I.S.E. Model

| STAGE                            | FOCUS                                         | SOURCE               |
|----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|----------------------|
| <b>W — Wisdom</b>                | Where does true insight begin?                | Dr. David Oyedepo    |
| <b>I — Inner Architecture</b>    | How do I build a mind that can receive it?    | Dr. Caroline Leaf    |
| <b>S — Spirit of Possibility</b> | What attitude enables me to act on it?        | Norman Vincent Peale |
| <b>E — Execution</b>             | How do I channel it into solutions and ideas? | de Bono + Young      |



Each stage depends on the one before it.

Together, they form a complete architecture for **Peak Thinking** and **Creative Problem-Solving**.

# Stage W: Winning Wisdom (Oyedepo)

W — Wisdom as Foundation



## The Central Claim

"Winning wisdom is the Supernatural Ability to bring solutions to matters too difficult for the ordinary human mind." — **Dr. David Oyedepo**

## What this means for problem-solving:

- 📖 The greatest answers are **received** by the prepared thinker — not manufactured — Jam 1:5
- ⚓ Wisdom is not the reward of more effort; it is the fruit of **divine connection**
- 🕒 **Before you develop your strategy, go to your Source — God**

# Wisdom Is Not Mental Exertion

What Wisdom IS and IS NOT — according to Dr Oyedepo



## Wisdom is NOT:

- ⊗ Thinking Harder
- ⊗ Researching More
- ⊗ Being more Disciplined

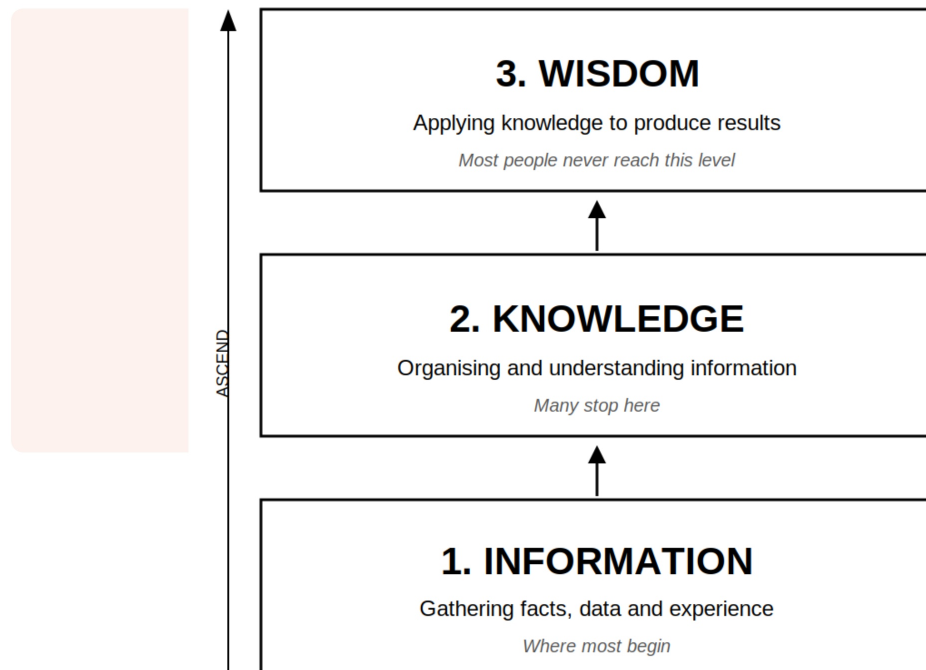
## Wisdom IS:

- 👁️ *"Uncovering God's approach to every issue of life"*
- 🕒 Knowing which way to go **before** the path is fully visible
- ⚡ The **application** of knowledge — not its mere accumulation

"The application of knowledge is what is called wisdom. Until a man amasses adequate knowledge, there will be nothing for him to use." — **Dr Oyedepo**

# The Knowledge-Wisdom Ladder

The Knowledge-Wisdom Ladder



**Key Insight:** Knowledge gives you **power**. Wisdom gives you **strength**. The leap from knowledge to wisdom requires more than study — it requires **seeking**.

# Stage I: Inner Architecture (Leaf)

## I — Inner Architecture



### The Core Discovery

Every thought you think  
**Physically Changes**  
the structure of your  
**brain** — Rom 12:2

- ↻ The brain is not fixed — it is a living, dynamic architecture you are constantly **building or dismantling**
- 👤 You are not a product of your **Neurology** — **you are its Architect**
- 🧠 The mind that is prepared to think well is the mind positioned to **receive wisdom**

**The Critical Link** — Dr. Oyedepo says wisdom must be *Received*.  
Leaf shows us the **Mechanism**.

# Toxic Thinking & the Creative Brain

Toxic Thinking: The Hidden Enemy of Creativity



## What toxic thinking does to your brain:

- ⚡ Triggers **cortisol and adrenaline** — the stress hormones
- ⊗ **Suppresses the prefrontal cortex** — the seat of creative thinking and sound judgement
- ⚠ Physically **damages** neural structures over time
- 🔒 Creates *brain automaticity* — locking the mind into the same habitual grooves

## The Problem-Solving Implication:

You cannot think your way out of a problem with a brain that fear has put into **survival mode** — Proverbs 23:7

The mind saturated with anxiety is neurologically incapable of its best **creative work**.

# The SWITCH Protocol

The 21-Day Brain Detox (Dr. Leaf's SWITCH Process)

| STEP                   | ACTION                                         |
|------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| S — Gather             | Become aware of the toxic thought              |
| W — Focused Reflection | Examine its root and emotional charge          |
| I — Write              | Externalise it in a journal                    |
| T — Revisit            | Review patterns and connections                |
| C — Active Reach       | Choose and rehearse the replacement thought    |
| H — Celebrate          | Acknowledge growth — reinforce the new pathway |



This is not motivational self-talk. It is a **scientifically grounded rewiring protocol.**

Each cycle literally builds **new neural structures.**

# Stage S: Spirit of Possibility (Peale)

Norman Vincent Peale — The Power of Positive Thinking



## The Central Claim

*"What you consistently believe about your situation determines what you will experience."* —  
Norman Vincent Peale

## Peale's role in the W.I.S.E. Model:

- ☆ Oyedepo establishes the *source*
- ⚙ Leaf prepares the *receiver*
- ⚡ Peale **fuels the engine**

A mind architecturally rebuilt (Leaf) but filled with doubt will not generate the confident, exploratory energy that **creative problem-solving demands**.

# The Five Principles of Positive Thinking

Five Principles That Power Creative Breakthroughs



| PRINCIPLE                        | WHAT IT MEANS                                                                                |
|----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Empty the mind of fear           | Fear and faith cannot coexist; fear is a cognitive contraction, not just an emotion          |
| Visualise the outcome            | Vivid mental rehearsal primes the brain for the result before it arrives                     |
| Affirm what you intend to become | The subconscious accepts what is repeatedly impressed upon it                                |
| Overcome the inferiority complex | The person who lacks <i>inner permission</i> will resist a breakthrough even when it arrives |
| Practise energised enthusiasm    | Sustained creative work demands sustained positive energy                                    |

# Fear, Faith, and the Creative Mind

## The Peale-Leaf-Oyedepo Connection



### Why Attitude Is Infrastructure

- **Peale said:** Fear and faith cannot occupy the mind simultaneously — choose faith.
- **Leaf confirmed:** Fear neurologically suppresses the prefrontal cortex — the very organ of **creative thinking**.
- **Dr. Oyedepo added:** *"Fear will come the way of people who don't regard God's Word, nor take His counsel seriously."*

### The unified message:

Fear is not a feeling to be managed — it is a **cognitive stance to be dismantled**.

All three authors prescribe **deliberate, active replacement** — not passive waiting for confidence to arrive.

# Stage E: Lateral Thinking (de Bono)

E — Execution: Think Differently



## The Problem de Bono

**Identified** — Most problems persist not because of lack of intelligence, but because of **Over-commitment to an existing pattern of thinking.**

### VERTICAL THINKING

Builds on what is known  
Seeks the one correct answer  
Efficient *within* a pattern

### LATERAL THINKING

Challenges what is known  
Explores many possible answers  
**Escapes** patterns entirely

The solutions too difficult for the ordinary mind cannot be reached by digging deeper in the same rut.

# Four Lateral Thinking Techniques

Four Tools for Escaping the Rut — Edward de Bono



- ✂ **1. Random Entry** — Introduce a random word and force a connection to the problem — the arbitrary link opens pathways the brain has never travelled.
- ⚡ **2. The Provocative Operation (Po)** — Make a deliberate, absurd statement about the problem to disrupt pattern-lock. *"Po: our product has no users."* — Follow the implications.
- 🔍 **3. Challenge Assumptions** — Surface every unexamined assumption beneath the problem and ask: *"Why must this be this way?"*
- 📦 **4. The Six Thinking Hats** — White (facts) · Red (emotion) · Black (caution) · Yellow (optimism) · Green (creativity) · Blue (process)

# Stage E: Technique for Producing Ideas

E — Execution: Produce Ideas Systematically (Young)



## The Central Claim:

The production of ideas is not a gift. It is a **process**. Anyone willing to follow it faithfully will produce ideas. — James Webb Young

## Two Foundational Principles:

### 1 New Combination

An idea is nothing more than a new combination of existing elements

### 2 See Relationships

The ability to form new combinations depends on the capacity to see relationships between things that appear unrelated

This is **de Bono's** lateral thinking expressed as a creative workflow — and **Dr. Oyedepo's** Knowledge-Wisdom Ladder expressed as a repeatable system.

# Young's 5-Step Creative Process

The Five Steps to Every Original Idea

| STEP                | ACTION                                             | W.I.S.E. CONNECTION          |
|---------------------|----------------------------------------------------|------------------------------|
| Gather Raw Material | Collect specific and general knowledge voraciously | Dr. Oyedepo's knowledge base |
| Digest the Material | Turn it over in your mind; let connections form    | Leaf's focused reflection    |
| Drop the Problem    | Release it entirely; let the subconscious work     | Peale's trust and release    |
| The Eureka Moment   | Capture the idea the instant it arrives            | de Bono's new vantage point  |
| Shape and Develop   | Refine through critical analysis and collaboration | Vertical thinking takes over |

# The Complete Creative Cycle

de Bono + Young: The Complete Creative Cycle



## How they work together:

- **Young** provides the *5-step process* — the architecture of idea production
- **de Bono** supplies tools — especially in Steps 1 and 2 — to break cognitive locks and broaden thinking
- In Step 5, **Young** relies on **de Bono's Vertical Thinking** to refine the raw idea

**de Bono** teaches you how to think **differently**.

**Young** teaches you how to produce ideas **systematically**.

# What All Five Authors Agree On

Across 5 decades, 5 disciplines — the same 5 convictions



## 1 The Mind is Primary

External circumstances matter far less than the quality of inner life

## 2 Patterns of Thought Can Be Changed

Intelligence and potential are developed, not fixed

## 3 Insight Is Prepared For, Not Waited For

Breakthroughs reward readiness, not passive waiting

## 4 Discomfort Is Part of the Process

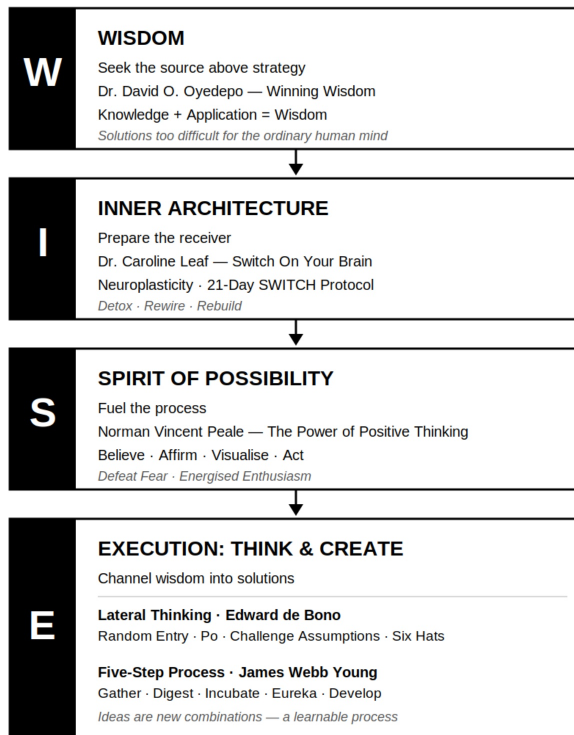
Growth always passes through resistance the undisciplined mind avoids

## 5 Wisdom, Thinking, and Creativity Are Not Separate Domains

They are one integrated capacity

# The W.I.S.E. Model: The Full Picture

## Putting It All Together



The **W.I.S.E.** Model is not a sequence to complete once — it is a cycle to inhabit continuously.

# Recommended Reading

Go Deeper: Recommended Reading



## The 5 Core Texts:

- **Oyedepo, D. O.** (1996) — *Winning Wisdom* · Dominion Publishing House
- **Leaf, C.** (2013) — *Switch On Your Brain* · Baker Books
- **Peale, N. V.** (1952) — *The Power of Positive Thinking* · Prentice-Hall
- **de Bono, E.** (1970) — *Lateral Thinking: Creativity Step by Step* · Harper & Row
- **Young, J. W.** (1939) — *A Technique for Producing Ideas* · NTC Business Books



# Thank You

Questions *and*  
Comments

